

Q.2a (20 marks): Mead's major contribution to anthropological theory was her demonstration of the importance of ...

- Q4. (a) Mead's major contribution to anthropological theory was her demonstration of the importance of cultural rather than biological conditioning. Elaborate with relevant examples and case studies. (20 marks)

Margaret Mead said that "BIOLOGY IS NOT DESTINY". She implied that culture and child rearing practices decide personality and not BIOLOGY.

Margaret Mead and Contributions :-

- ① Sex and Temperament in 3 Primitive Societies :-

She studied the ARAPESH, MUNDUGUMOR (BIWAT), TSCHAMBULI (CHAMB). These cultures lived in same environment but had different cultures and personalities.

1.1) ARAPESH :- They were a cooperative culture that did imitative magic for welfare. Men and women were equal. The children were docile and friendly ("feminine traits").

1.2) MUNDUGUMOR :- They had constant conflicts in family. Polygamy created mistrust and conflict in society. Thus

children were reared to be aggressive and violent.

CHAMBLI
1.3 : Women dominated the culture, they were property holders and had essential socio-religious role.

The women dominated the men and men remained weak and docile.

⊗ **THUS CULTURE CONDITIONS CHILD PSYCHOLOGY AND LEADS TO ADULT BEHAVIOUR.**

2] Case Coming up of African Samoa:-

She compared adolescence of Samoa children and American.

2.1) Samoa children were taught to be obedient and mindful of cultural values.

2.2) In adolescence, premarital relations & such exposure was not proscribed.

2.3) Adolescents remained peaceful, happy and forward looking.

She contrasted this with American adolescence which was full of storm and stress"

Cross Cultural Comparisons	
Samoa	America
no storm and stress	storm & stress
Easy transition to sexual maturity	Turbulent transition

These differences due to cultural conditioning.

3) "Growing up in New Guinea": She studied Manus tribe where culture decided personality and not Biology.

4) "Male and Female": In this she said that gendered socialisation in miles of culture lead to differences in the sexes. She said "GENDER IS NOT BIOLOGY, it is CULTURAL".

5) Use of Visual Anthropology in Balinese study: "GROWTH OF A CULTURE": A

Photographic Analysis of Bahuini:

In this she said that while taking photographs, the elders often DIRECTED the young ones and showed them poses. Thus cultural influences are important for conditioning.

Thus she showed that culture forms personality and this creates adult choices, human behaviour and worldviews.

Criticisms of Mead :-

- (1) D. Friedman said interpretation was anecdotal and stom was found in Samoa.
- (2) Interpretation of Chambri culture was incorrect as men also were present.
- (3) Margaret Harris criticised Samoa study and said infrastructure determines culture, not just the conditioning.

However, her contribution can be used to study sports culture in Mangana - the role of female sports persons & conditioning.